QP CODE: 25900581

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025Third SEMESTER

Value Addition Course (VAC) - MG3VACJMC200, MG3VACPJM201

CITIZEN JOURNALISM

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration : 1 Hour 30 Minutes Maximum Marks: 50

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation (Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Multiple Choice Questions

Answer all questions Each question carries 1marks **[1x15 = 15]**

1. The “Citizen Journalist Show” was launched by: [K] / [CO2

c). CNN-IBN

2. A press release is an example of which type of news source?

a). Primary [K] / [CO2]

3. Citizen journalists should avoid which of the following ethical breaches?

a). Plagiarism and failing to acknowledge sources [U] / [CO3]

4. Technological affordances of ..... revolutionised citizen journalism [U] / [CO1]

c). Digital media

5. Which of the following is a group interview forma

c). Vox-pop [K] / [CO2]

6. Which feature is common in VN and Power Director?

d). Adding transitions [K] / [CO2]

7. Which of the following best defines news? [K] / [CO2]

c). Information about recent events of public interest

8. What do you call journalism published via websites, blogs, or social media? [U] / [CO3]

c). Online/Digital journalism

9. Citizen journalists must avoid publishing: [K] / [CO2]

b). Defamatory content

10. Identify the event that triggered citizen involvement in journalism worldwide

a). Asian Tsunami in 2004 [K] / [CO1]

11. Identify the fundamental right that is realized in the practice of citizen journalism

a). Right to free speech [U] / [CO1]

12. Which of the following is NOT part of reporting?

c). Adding personal bias [K] / [CO2]

13. An ethical citizen journalist should aim to: [U] / [CO3]

b) Present balanced perspectives and multiple view points

14. PARI's citizen journalism helps in:

a) Highlighting rural traditions and livelihoods [U] / [CO3]

15. Which value is part of journalistic ethics?

a). Accuracy [K] / [CO4]

Part B : Short Answer Type Questions (100 Words)

Answer any 5 questions Each question carries 3 marks [3x5 = 15]

16. Explain fairness as a journalistic principle U] / [CO1]

Fairness requires journalists to explore and present all sides of a story. This means giving equal opportunity for different perspectives to be heard, especially in contentious or complex issues. Journalists should prioritize truth and transparency over speed or popularity, ensuring the public receives trustworthy content**.**

17. State three advantages of using smartphones for reporting. [K] / [CO2]

Smartphones allow journalists to quickly record high-quality photos, videos, and audio, making it easier to document events as they unfold. Smartphones combine camera, editing apps, communication tools, and publishing platforms in one device, streamlining the entire reporting process**.**

18. Analyse why fact-checking is crucial in the digital news environment- [An] / [CO4]

Fact-checking helps prevent the viral spread of falsehoods that can mislead the public. In a fast-paced digital environment, maintaining trust is essential. Fact-checking ensures that journalists uphold integrity and accuracy, reinforcing public confidence in their reporting. Digital journalism benefits

from tools like reverse image searches, geolocation, and AI-assisted verification. These technologies enhance the ability to detect and correct misinformation efficiently.

19. What is in-depth journalism [U] / [CO1]

In-depth journalism involves extensive research and reporting to uncover the full scope of a story. Journalists dig deep into facts, data, and sources to provide a comprehensive understanding of complex issues. It goes beyond surface-level reporting by offering background, context, and expert analysis. This helps readers grasp the significance and implications of the story.

20. Define blogging. Name one popular blogging platform - [K] / [CO2]

Blogging is the act of writing and publishing content on the internet, typically in the form of articles or posts, often on a specific topic or niche. Blogs can be personal journals, professional insights, news updates, or educational resources, and they allow individuals or organizations to share their thoughts, expertise, and stories with a global audience.

21. Discuss role of ethics in journalism [U] / [CO1]

Explain on Truth and Accuracy, Independence, Fairness and Impartiality, Accountability, Respect for Privacy and Dignity.

22. Why is defamation considered harmful in journalism? [K] / [CO2]

Defamation involves publishing false statements that harm an individual's or organization's reputation. This can lead to personal distress, professional setbacks, and social stigma. Explain on Damages Reputation, Legal Consequences, Undermines Public Trust, Violates Ethical Standards.

23. Write on a prominent example of alternate journalism in India. [K] / [CO3]

Khabar Lahariya, Najir Hussain's Initiatives, PARI etc.

Part C: Essay Type Questions (350 Words)

Answer any 2 questions Each question carries 10 marks [10x2 = 20]

24. Outline the importance of vlogging in sharing information with the public. [K] / [CO2]

Vlogs are visually dynamic and emotionally resonant, making them more engaging than text-based content. Explain Global Reach, Simplifies Complex Information, Authentic Voice, Mobile-Friendly Format, Versatile Content Delivery, Interactive Communication, Influence and Advocacy, Data-Driven Insights.

25. Elaborate the idea of citizen media and its growing salience in the present [U] / [CO1]

Citizen media allows everyday people—not just professional journalists—to report news, share opinions, and document events using smartphones, blogs, and social platforms. This democratizes information and gives voice to underrepresented communities. Real-Time, On-the-Ground Reporting, It amplifies Marginalized Voices and fuelled by Technology and social media. As citizen media grows, mainstream outlets are adapting by incorporating user-generated content and engaging with grassroots narratives. It's reshaping how news is sourced, verified, and consumed

26. In the world of media, images can make or break a news. Discuss [U] / [CO1]

Images evoke emotions faster than words. A powerful photo can stir empathy, outrage, or hope, making the story more compelling and memorable. It enhances comprehension, authenticates the story. Manipulated images can distort facts, sensationalize events, or reinforce bias. Ethical image selection is crucial to maintain journalistic integrity. In the age of social media, striking visuals are more likely to be clicked, shared, and remembered. They often determine whether a story goes viral or gets ignored.

27. List the elements of news and state their significance [K] / [CO2]

News must be current. The more recent the event, the more relevant it is to the audience. Timely reporting keeps the public informed about what's happening now. Explain Timeliness, Proximity, Impact, Prominence, Conflict, Human Interest